

ALCHEMY AOE ALLIANCE

**TYPE:
HANDBOOK
(HDBK)**



**PROJECT:
N/A**

HDBK--L009

REVISION: R6

Handbook, Alchemy League Season 9

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1 - Referenced Documents

Table 1 below is a list of all specifications that are components to this one. Each of its entries were designed as an interchangeable part, to be used in context for this specification, or others like it:

Specification Number	Nomenclature
<u>MTHD-002</u>	Calculation, Tournament Elo
<u>MTHD-003</u>	Elo Correction, Handicap
<u>MTHD-004</u>	Discipline, Pa2 Round Robin
<u>MTHD-005</u>	Winner Selection, Round Robin
<u>MTHD-006</u>	Earnings, Round Robin
<u>MTHD-007</u>	Structure, Single Division Stack League
<u>MTHD-009</u>	Elo Calculation, Final
<u>MTHD-010</u>	Alchemy Treasury
<u>PSRM-RAND-1</u>	Super Random Maps
<u>STND-005</u>	Competition, General Rules

Table 1: Bill of Materials

If any part of any documents listed in Table 1 conflict with this specification, then this specification shall assume priority.

2 - Background

The *Alchemy Alliance (ALAL)* is a free and non-profit organization of random map scripters, tournament hosts, content creators, and skilled players dedicated to the advancement of custom random maps in Age of Empires II: Definitive Edition. As the nucleus of the *Alchemy AOE Community*, the *ALAL* publishes quality standards for custom random maps, and curates the finished products to be featured into thematic competitions where adventuresome players may exhibit creative strategies for maximum entertainment value.



3 - Overview

This handbook describes Alchemy League, a unique Age of Empires II 1v1 competition hosted by the *Alchemy Alliance*. As the most advanced AOE2 tournament in the world, Alchemy League boasts “big data” averaging of ranked elo calculation, a trade-secret single division stack matchmaker, and prizes awarded to players who most over-perform predictions. For maximum variety and entertainment, Alchemy League is played on Custom Maps with Standard Victory conditions.

4 - Prize Money

Prize Money Details per Table 4 below:

Title	Amount	Details
Maximum Possible Winners per Sprint	[4,6,12]	Top Performers per <u>MTHD-005</u> , having played more than 50% of minimum assigned games.
Skill Bias Exponent	1.25	Distributed Among Winning Players per <u>MTHD-006</u> .
Prizes, Sprint 1	\$40 USDC	
Prizes, Sprint 2	\$60 USDC	
Prizes, Sprint 3	\$200 USDC	Added to Prizes for Each Winner
Currency Conversion Credit per Winner per Sprint	\$1.50 USDC	
Payment Platform	~	Disbursed per <u>MTHD-010</u>
Country of Payment Origin	~	United States of America

Table 4: Prize Money Information



5 - Timeline

Start Date (YY-MM-DD)	End Date (YY-MM-DD)	Milestone(s):	Sprint
~	2026-01-05	Registrations Open	
2026-01-07	2026-01-20	Round 1	Sprint 1
2026-01-14	2026-01-27	Round 2	
2026-01-28	2026-02-03	Break, Calculate Scores & Winnings	
2026-02-04	2026-02-17	Round 3	Sprint 2
2026-02-11	2026-02-24	Round 4	
2026-02-25	2026-03-03	Break, Calculate Scores & Winnings	
2026-03-04	2026-03-17	Round 5	Sprint 3
2026-03-11	2026-03-24	Round 6	
2026-03-18	2026-03-31	Round 7	
2026-03-25	2026-04-07	Round 8	
2026-04-01	2026-04-14	Round 9	
2026-04-08	2026-04-21	Round 10	
2026-04-22	2026-04-23	Calculate Scores & Winnings	
2026-04-24	2026-04-25	Winners Provide Payment Addresses	
2026-04-26	2026-04-27	Earnings Sent, Season Ends	

Table 5: Timeline, Alchemy League, This Season



6 - League Format

Title	Min	Max	Details
Team Size	~	~	1v1
Division Count	1	1	Round Robin per <u>MTHD-007</u> .
Number of Sprints	3	3	
Rounds per Sprint	[2,2,6]	[2,2,6]	
Games per Round	2	3	For each round, competing players agree on the number of games they want to play. That number must be greater than or equal to the minimum, and less than or equal to the maximum. Players may decide at any point during their set how many games to play, but once a game has begun, it cannot be aborted to prevent a loss. All games played in this format shall inform results and payout calculation.
Early Play Option	~	~	Returning League Players who will be traveling or otherwise unavailable for an extended period of time, eclipsing the majority of any one Round may request to play their set early. All participants shall accommodate exceptions granted in this manner. If the tournament assigns a map for that Round, it shall apply regardless of when the set is played. Only one exception per player may be granted by the tournament host per Sprint, and the early play option shall be requested <i>prior to registration</i> . In this way, a player may decline to register if exception is not granted.

Table 6: League Format Information



7 - Tournament Elo

Title	Details
Data Collection, Step 1	Reference internet APIs to garner all alternate or “smurf” accounts corresponding to the same player, derived through IP address, Steam account sharing, and other methods.
Data Collection, Step 2	Reference internet APIs to harvest all relevant match history corresponding to each of the accounts gathered from the previous step.
Average Ranked Elo, Formula	Calculated from 100 most recent games, linearly weighted per <u>MTHD-002</u> .
Average Ranked Elo, Confidence Window	Perform a tolerance sweep on win rate and elo fluctuation over history to estimate a range of possible tournament elos for each participant, with 100% confidence interval.
Average Ranked Elo, Final Value	Take average ranked elo as the $\frac{3}{4}$ point going from minimum to maximum within confidence window.
Tournament Elo, final Value	Average Ranked Elo ($\frac{3}{4}$ point) adjusted for returning players inactive in ranked per <u>MTHD-009</u> .
Handicap	For each matched set of players, 100 shall be added to the lower of two elos and then <u>MTHD-003</u> applied to determine corrective handicap.

Table 7: Tournament Elo Information

8 - Custom Map Information

Title	Details
Map Qualities	Super Random Custom Maps per <u>PSRM-RAND-1</u> .
Featured Map	For each non-wild round, the tournament host will declare a map from the pool to be “Map of the Round”. Unless there are more rounds than available maps, a map cannot be “Map of the Round” twice in the same season.
Obtaining Maps	To protect creator intellectual property rights, the Alchemy AOE Community does not upload competition resources to the in-game mod center. Participants shall download the latest Alchemy League map scripts and place them in a folder suitable for integration into the game. Recommended approach (~30 seconds): download and run the following open-source batch script: <u>Download .bat file here</u>. This executable was written by the community to automatically download and move the latest version of each map in the pack from the online repository to the correct location. It is used by most players. Direct control (~2 minutes): download the “Map_Archive” zip file from the Alchemy AOE Season web-page and unzip to the appropriate game folder. Note that the direct download is required for non-Windows users. The Alchemy AOE Community server is webhook-configured to notify players of any changes to the random map Github repository –the source of the custom map pool. Players are responsible for making sure they are using the latest versions by re-downloading after a map is updated. Tournament staff are eager to assist as needed.
Map Selection, Round Wild	Each player selects a home map, then they take turns discarding the remainder from the available draft. If additional games are played, then the maps used are in reverse order of the discard.
Map Selection, Rounds Normal	The first map is the “Map of the Round”. Then, players take turns discarding the remaining maps until only one remains, which the second game is played on. If additional games are played, then it is selected from the available pool by whoever currently has fewer wins in that set, OR by the lower seed, if players are tied.

Table 8: Custom Map Information

9 - General Settings

Title	Details
Civilization Selection	Civilization Draft consists of five administrative bans, followed by 2 bans each, then 4 picks each, then one snipe each (hidden and parallel), and ends with two picks each. The following civilizations are not eligible for drafting: Inca, Jurchens, Khitans, Shu, Wei, Wu, Mapuche, Muisca, and Tupi.
Tournament Server	https://discord.gg/h9DvzHBNPr
Tournament Host	TechChariot
General Rules	Per <u>STND-005</u> .
Discipline	Administrative penalties assigned per <u>MTHD-004</u> . Maximum possible penalties per Sprint equal to 2 times the number of contained Rounds.
First Sprint Eligibility	Participants shall have 100 1v1 games minimum and win rate between 15% and 85% totaled across all accounts.
Other Sprint Eligibility	Participants shall complete all previous Sprints without accumulation of excessive administrative penalties. Returning Players in good standing <i>may</i> elect to compete in their choice of First or Second Sprints in order to Qualify for Sprint 3.
Open Registration, Access Link	https://forms.gle/1LDUBw6x2HS1QMfJA
First Sprint All Signups, Access Link	https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1KHb05yNB0YNEbGDsBED-Vku-Cs1ZVmdQr6I52ZegNEQ/edit?usp=sharing
Other Sprint Registration	Eligible players auto-enrolled in subsequent Sprints unless otherwise indicated at least 24 hours before start.

Table 10: General Settings



10 - Support

The Alchemy Treasury graciously accepts donations within the constraints of MTHD-010. Many thanks to the patrons who make Alchemy League possible.



Signatures:

TechChariot

2025-11-21

Prepared

*Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*Jasouki

2025-11-28

Checked

*Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*Honeybadger

2025-11-28

Approved

Date (YYYY-MM-DD)

Revision History:

<u>Revision</u>	Description	Change Document	Date (YYYY-MM-DD)																																																																	
X1	-- Advanced Release for Community Review --	N/A	2025-05-15																																																																	
OI	---- Original Issue ----	N/A	2025-11-28																																																																	
R1	§5, Table – Added Row 1 (“Milestone, Registrations Open”)	N/A	2025-12-06																																																																	
R2	Revised document number in the header of all pages (except pg 1) FROM “L008” TO “L009”.	N/A	2026-01-05																																																																	
R3	§4, Table – Cell (2,2) Revised FROM: “[6,6,10]” TO “[4,6,12]” §4, Table – Cell (4,2) Revised FROM: “\$60 USDC” TO “\$40 USDC” §4, Table – Cell (6,2) Revised FROM: “\$180 USDC” TO “\$200 USDC” §5, Table – Revised FROM: <table border="1" data-bbox="373 1071 998 1648"> <thead> <tr> <th>Start Date (YY-MM-DD)</th><th>End Date (YY-MM-DD)</th><th>Milestone(s):</th><th>Sprint</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>~</td><td>2026-01-05</td><td>Registrations Open</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-01-07</td><td>2026-01-20</td><td>Round 1</td><td rowspan="3">Sprint 1</td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-01-14</td><td>2026-01-28</td><td>Round 2</td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-01-21</td><td>2026-02-03</td><td>Round 3</td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-02-04</td><td>2026-02-10</td><td>Break, Calculate Scores & Winnings</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-02-11</td><td>2026-02-24</td><td>Round 4</td><td rowspan="3">Sprint 2</td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-02-18</td><td>2026-03-03</td><td>Round 5</td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-02-25</td><td>2026-03-10</td><td>Round 6</td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-03-11</td><td>2026-03-17</td><td>Break, Calculate Scores & Winnings</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-03-18</td><td>2026-03-31</td><td>Round 7</td><td rowspan="4">Sprint 3</td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-03-25</td><td>2026-04-07</td><td>Round 8</td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-04-01</td><td>2026-04-14</td><td>Round 9</td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-04-08</td><td>2026-04-21</td><td>Round 10</td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-04-15</td><td>2026-04-28</td><td>Round 11</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-04-29</td><td>2026-05-01</td><td>Calculate Scores & Winnings</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-05-02</td><td>2026-05-03</td><td>Winners Provide Payment Addresses</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>2026-05-04</td><td>2026-05-06</td><td>Earnings Sent, Season Ends</td><td></td></tr> </tbody> </table> <i>Table 5: Timeline, Alchemy League, This Season</i> TO: [Current Contents] §6, Table – Cells (5,2:3) Revised FROM: “[3,3,5]” TO “[2,2,6]”	Start Date (YY-MM-DD)	End Date (YY-MM-DD)	Milestone(s):	Sprint	~	2026-01-05	Registrations Open		2026-01-07	2026-01-20	Round 1	Sprint 1	2026-01-14	2026-01-28	Round 2	2026-01-21	2026-02-03	Round 3	2026-02-04	2026-02-10	Break, Calculate Scores & Winnings		2026-02-11	2026-02-24	Round 4	Sprint 2	2026-02-18	2026-03-03	Round 5	2026-02-25	2026-03-10	Round 6	2026-03-11	2026-03-17	Break, Calculate Scores & Winnings		2026-03-18	2026-03-31	Round 7	Sprint 3	2026-03-25	2026-04-07	Round 8	2026-04-01	2026-04-14	Round 9	2026-04-08	2026-04-21	Round 10	2026-04-15	2026-04-28	Round 11		2026-04-29	2026-05-01	Calculate Scores & Winnings		2026-05-02	2026-05-03	Winners Provide Payment Addresses		2026-05-04	2026-05-06	Earnings Sent, Season Ends		N/A	2026-01-05
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HDBK--L009		Handbook, Alchemy League Season 9		REV: R6
R4	§5, Table, Rows 6 & 7, Column 4 – Revised FROM: “Sprint 1” TO “Sprint 2” (minor copy-paste error fix)	N/A	2026-02-02	
R5	§9, Table, Rows 2, Column 2 ADDED: “Note that the reworked Incas are forbidden for this season.”	N/A	2026-02-17	
R6	§9, Table, Rows 2, Column 2 revised FROM: “Note that the reworked Incas are forbidden for this season.” TO: “The following civilizations are not eligible for drafting: Inca, Jurchens, Khitans, Shu, Wei, Wu, Mapuche, Muisca, and Tupi.”	N/A	2026-02-21	

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